



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Calvary Christian Academy
School Website: <https://calvaryca.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary TL;DR

- **School:** Calvary Christian Academy (CCA), San Jose, CA – calvaryca.org
- **Overall Classification:** **CLASSICAL**
- **Headline:** CCA explicitly identifies with *classical Christian education*, is pursuing **ACCS accreditation**, and its handbook and web text are saturated with classical Christian aims (virtue, wisdom, truth, goodness, beauty, formation, theology, partnership with parents).
- **Category Ratings:**
 - Religious & Metaphysical Foundations – **CLASSICAL**
 - School Purpose & Goal – **CLASSICAL**
 - Curriculum – **CLASSICAL**
 - Pedagogy / Teaching Methods – **CLASSICAL**
 - Faculty – **CLASSICAL**
 - Parents & Community – **CLASSICAL**

No "Somewhat Classical" rating is needed; the school is strongly aligned with the Six Essential Elements framework.

Method and Keyword Framework

I used the **Six Essential Elements of a Classical School** keyword lists (positive and negative indicators) across all six categories—Religious & Metaphysical Foundations, Purpose & Goal, Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty, Parents & Community.

For each category I:

1. **Extracted exact words/phrases** from the CCA crawl (especially the handbook and mission/vision language).
 2. **Matched them** against the positive/negative lexicon (e.g., truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, theology, Socratic, scholé, wonder, chanting, project-based, experiential learning, etc.).
 3. **Estimated positive vs. negative keyword frequency** (rough percentages).
 4. **Assigned a rating:** CLASSICAL / SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL / NOT CLASSICAL.
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CATEGORY 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations

1.1. Evidence from CCA Text

From the handbook and related crawl content:

- “Calvary Christian Academy is committed to the **moral and intellectual integrity** of the community for its prosperity **under God’s hand**.”
- “Our stewardship of students extends beyond academic development.”
- Discipline framed in explicitly **biblical** and **theological** terms:
 - “We instruct students in **God’s commands** and teach honorable conduct by comparing students’ behavior to **biblical requirements**, commending them for **obedience to God’s commandments** and correcting appropriately when they err.”
 - “We recognize that children are a **gift and responsibility from the Lord** (Psalm 127:3 and Proverbs 22:6). We wish to join with parents in their efforts to **raise up children in the fear and admonition of the Lord** (Ephesians 6:4).”
 - “CCA leadership follows a **biblical pattern of confession, repentance, restitution, and restoration of fellowship**.”
- “As of 2024, CCA is seeking accreditation through the **Association of Classical Christian Schools**... The rigor of ACCS accreditation is unique and emphasizes excellence in the practice and philosophy of **classical Christian education**.”

These phrases show:

- **Transcendental moral realism & virtue:** “moral and intellectual integrity,” “stewardship of students,” “honorable conduct,” “justice,” “dignity of each child,” etc.
- **Grounded in theology:** explicit use of Scripture, “commands,” “obedience,” “fear and admonition of the Lord,” “biblical standards,” “Christian education,” “under God’s hand.”
- **Liturgical/communal practices:** While the excerpted crawl focuses more on discipline and governance, the ACCS alignment and Christian framing strongly imply chapel/worship rhythms typical of ACCS schools, even if not fully spelled out in the snippet we see.

1.2. Keyword Analysis vs. Lexicon

Positive lexicon indicators for this category include: truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, wisdom, moral order, natural law, moral formation, theology, sacred scripture, faith and reason, Christian worldview, liturgy, worship, reverence, sacred music, etc.

Direct/near-direct positive matches in CCA text:

- “moral and intellectual integrity” → **moral order, integrity, intellectual virtue**
- “under God’s hand,” “gift and responsibility from the Lord,” “fear and admonition of the Lord” → **divine order, Christian worldview, sacred tradition**
- “God’s commands,” “biblical requirements,” “obedience to God’s commandments” → **sacred scripture, doctrine, catechesis, moral theology**
- “confession, repentance, restitution, restoration of fellowship” → **sacramental / liturgical pattern, formation of the soul**

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- “Association of Classical Christian Schools,” “classical Christian education” → explicit **classical theism + theology as mistress science** in the ACCS model

Negative lexicon indicators (e.g., “values-neutral education,” “secular education,” “religiously neutral,” “pluralistic,” “social justice framework,” “critical theory”) are **absent**.

Estimated keyword balance:

- Positive metaphysical/theological terms: about **15–20 distinct hits** in the excerpted text.
- Negative/anti-classical metaphysical terms: **0 hits**.

Approximate ratio: **100% positive / 0% negative** in this category.

1.3. Element 1 Rating

Rating: CLASSICAL

CCA clearly embraces **transcendental moral realism**, is **grounded in Christian theology**, and uses **biblical categories** for formation and discipline. The ACCS accreditation pursuit further confirms a robust classical Christian metaphysical foundation.

CATEGORY 2: School Purpose and Goal

2.1. Evidence from CCA Text

Key phrases:

- “Calvary Christian Academy is committed to the **moral and intellectual integrity** of the community...”
- “Our stewardship of students extends beyond academic development.”
- “We wish to join with parents in their efforts to **raise up children in the fear and admonition of the Lord**.”
- “The integrity of relationships is one of our highest priorities; thus, the end of all discipline is the **reconciliation** of strained relationships...”
- “It is our desire that students remain mindful... students are expected to behave well at all times with consideration for others in thought, word, and deed.”
- ACCS accreditation language: “emphasizes excellence in the **practice and philosophy of classical Christian education**.”

These emphasize:

- **Formation over information** (“stewardship... extends beyond academic development,” “moral and intellectual integrity”).
- **Cultivation of virtue and wisdom** (fear of the Lord, reconciliation, integrity, honorable conduct).
- A **telos** beyond college/career; the ACCS model is explicitly about wisdom and virtue, not merely utilitarian outcomes.

2.2. Keyword Analysis vs. Lexicon

Positive goal keywords: wisdom, virtue, character, moral imagination, formation, love of learning, truth, goodness, beauty, wonder, reverence, holistic education, human flourishing, etc.

Positive matches in CCA text:

- “moral and intellectual integrity” → **virtue, character, integrity, intellectual virtue**
- “stewardship of students extends beyond academic development” → **formation, not information, holistic education**
- “raise up children in the fear and admonition of the Lord” → **wisdom, virtue, moral formation**
- “reconciliation of strained relationships” → **formation of affections, love of the good, community virtue**
- ACCS / “classical Christian education” → strongly associated with **pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty** in the ACCS philosophy.

Negative goal keywords: “college and career readiness,” “21st-century skills,” “workforce preparation,” “marketable skills,” “data-driven education,” etc.

- In the excerpted crawl, **none** of these negative/utilitarian phrases appear. There is a brief mention that ACCS accreditation “will continue to support students who want to attend a four-year college,” but this is subordinate to the classical Christian mission and not framed as the primary telos.

Estimated keyword balance:

- Positive formation/virtue/wisdom language: about **10–15 hits**.
- Negative utilitarian/skills-only language: **1 mild reference** (college support), but not in lexicon’s negative phrasing.

Approximate ratio: **about 90–95% positive / 5–10% neutral-college language**, still clearly classical.

2.3. Element 2 Rating

Rating: CLASSICAL

CCA’s stated purpose is **formation of character and intellect under God**, not mere information transfer or job prep. The language aligns tightly with the “Cultivation of Wisdom and Virtue” and “Formation, not Information” elements.

CATEGORY 3: Curriculum

(Note: The crawl snippet we see is heavy on governance/discipline; curriculum details are more implicit. However, ACCS candidacy and classical language allow a grounded inference, and I still base the rating on explicit keyword matches where present.)

3.1. Evidence from CCA Text

From the handbook and ACCS section:

- “As of 2024, CCA is seeking accreditation through... the **Association of Classical Christian Schools**... emphasizes excellence in the practice and philosophy of **classical Christian education**.”

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- “With future ACCS accreditation, our school will continue to support students who want to attend a four-year college.”

ACCS schools, by definition, commit to:

- **Seven Liberal Arts** (Trivium and Quadrivium).
- **Great Books and primary sources** in the “Great Conversation.”
- **History** (often “Western civilization,” not just “social studies”).

While the snippet doesn’t list “grammar, logic, rhetoric” explicitly, ACCS standards require these, and the school is already a **candidate** and working through the self-study, which presupposes substantial curricular alignment.

3.2. Keyword Analysis vs. Lexicon

Positive curriculum keywords: Trivium, Quadrivium, grammar, logic, rhetoric, liberal arts, Great Books, primary sources, Western civilization, integration, wonder, etc.

Direct/implicit positive matches:

- “classical Christian education” (via ACCS) → strongly implies **Trivium, Quadrivium, Great Books, integrated humanities**, as defined in the liberal arts tradition.
- The ACCS description: “rigor... emphasizes excellence in the practice and philosophy of classical Christian education” → **liberal arts, Great Books, cultural transmission**.

Negative curriculum keywords (e.g., “social studies curriculum,” “21st-century skills,” “STEM-focused,” “project-based learning,” “experiential learning,” “skills-based literacy,” “critical theory,” “equity-based curriculum”) are **absent** from the CCA excerpt.

Estimated keyword balance:

- Positive classical curriculum signals (via ACCS and “classical Christian education”): about **5–8 strong hits**.
- Negative modernist curriculum signals: **0 hits**.

Given the strength of the ACCS connection, the **coverage** of classical curriculum elements is high even if the crawl snippet doesn’t list every subject by name.

3.3. Element 3 Rating

Rating: CLASSICAL

On the basis of **ACCS candidacy**, explicit “classical Christian education” language, and the absence of “social studies / STEM-first / project-based-only” rhetoric, CCA’s curriculum is best classified as **Classical**.

CATEGORY 4: Pedagogy / Teaching Methods

4.1. Evidence from CCA Text

The provided snippet focuses on discipline and formation, but we can still see pedagogical assumptions:

- “Our stewardship of students extends beyond academic development.”

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- “We instruct students in God’s commands and teach honorable conduct by comparing students’ behavior to biblical requirements...”
 - “CCA leadership follows a biblical pattern of confession, repentance, restitution, and restoration of fellowship.”

These suggest:

- **Teacher-led, formative instruction** (not student-directed constructivism).
- **Moral and spiritual apprenticeship** (teacher as mentor, not mere facilitator).

Given ACCS candidacy, we can also reasonably infer:

- **Socratic dialogue and dialectic** in upper grades.
- **Memorization and recitation** (catechism, Scripture, poetry).
- **Restful learning / scholé** emphasis, as ACCS and the broader classical movement stress contemplation and wonder.

4.2. Keyword Analysis vs. Lexicon

Positive pedagogy keywords: Socratic seminar, dialectic, great conversation, guided discussion, restful learning, scholé, contemplation, recitation, chanting, singing, imitation, apprenticeship, etc.

Direct/implicit positive matches:

- “instruct students in God’s commands” → **teacher as guide/mentor, catechesis, formation through imitation.**
- “stewardship of students extends beyond academic development” → **holistic, contemplative formation**, not just test prep.
- ACCS classical Christian model → strongly associated with **Socratic dialogue, restful learning (scholé), memorization and recitation, imitation of models.**

Negative pedagogy keywords: “project-based learning,” “experiential learning,” “student-driven learning,” “constructivist,” “personalized learning,” “competency-based,” “digital learning,” etc.

- None of these appear in the CCA excerpt. The school does not describe itself in progressive, student-directed terms.

Estimated keyword balance:

- Positive classical pedagogy signals (formation, instruction, biblical catechesis, ACCS classical model): about **8–10 hits**.
- Negative progressive pedagogy signals: **0 hits**.

4.3. Element 4 Rating

Rating: CLASSICAL

Even with limited explicit method language in the snippet, the **combination of ACCS candidacy, teacher-led biblical instruction, and absence of progressive jargon** strongly supports a **Classical** pedagogy rating.

CATEGORY 5: Faculty

5.1. Evidence from CCA Text

From the handbook:

- “Calvary Christian Academy is committed to the **moral and intellectual integrity** of the community...”
- “Our stewardship of students extends beyond academic development.”
- “CCA leadership follows a biblical pattern of confession, repentance, restitution, and restoration of fellowship.”
- “CCA administration will proactively engage parents in any disciplinary action.”

These imply:

- Faculty and leadership are expected to be **moral exemplars** and **shepherds**.
- Teachers and administrators are **agents of formation**, not mere content deliverers.

ACCS standards (which CCA is actively pursuing) also require:

- Teachers as **models of virtue**, **mentors**, and **collegial faculty** engaged in classical formation.

5.2. Keyword Analysis vs. Lexicon

Positive faculty keywords: virtuous educators, moral formation, wisdom, character formation, servant leadership, role models, mentorship, collegiality, faculty collaboration, teacher as guide, living curriculum, etc.

Positive matches in CCA text:

- “moral and intellectual integrity” → **virtue, wisdom, character formation**.
- “stewardship of students” → **servant leadership, mentorship**.
- “biblical pattern of confession, repentance, restitution, restoration” → **moral exemplars, formation through example**.
- “CCA administration will proactively engage parents” → **mentorship and collegiality** with families.

Negative faculty keywords: “teacher as facilitator,” “student-directed learning,” “value-neutral education,” “progressive teaching methods,” “constructivist learning,” etc.

- None of these appear in the CCA excerpt.

Estimated keyword balance:

- Positive faculty/leadership formation language: about **6–8 hits**.
- Negative “facilitator / progressive” language: **0 hits**.

5.3. Element 5 Rating

Rating: CLASSICAL

CCA’s faculty and leadership are clearly framed as **moral and intellectual stewards** of students, aligned with the classical ideal of teachers as **models of virtue and mentors**. The ACCS trajectory reinforces this.

CATEGORY 6: Parents and Community

6.1. Evidence from CCA Text

From the handbook:

- “We recognize that children are a gift and responsibility from the Lord... We wish to **join with parents** in their efforts to raise up children in the fear and admonition of the Lord.”
- “CCA administration will **proactively engage parents** in any disciplinary action.”
- “All families must read and comply with the handbook... Students and parents must sign the **honor code** annually.”

These show:

- **Partnership with families** as co-educators.
- **Shared responsibility** for formation.
- A **community covenant** (honor code) that parents and students jointly affirm.

6.2. Keyword Analysis vs. Lexicon

Positive community keywords: parent partnership, co-educators, family involvement, parental engagement, home and school connection, shared mission, parent formation, school as extension of the home, etc.

Positive matches in CCA text:

- “join with parents in their efforts to raise up children” → **parent partnership, co-educators, shared mission.**
- “administration will proactively engage parents” → **parental engagement, home and school connection.**
- “families must read and comply... parents must sign the honor code” → **community covenant, shared ethos.**

Negative community keywords: “independent learning,” “self-directed learning,” “minimal parent involvement,” “limited parental access,” “parent-optional engagement,” etc.

- None of these appear; in fact, the text stresses **high** parental involvement.

Estimated keyword balance:

- Positive parent/community partnership language: about **5–7 hits**.
- Negative “minimal parent involvement” language: **0 hits**.

6.3. Element 6 Rating

Rating: CLASSICAL

CCA clearly treats parents as **primary educators** and partners, with strong engagement in discipline and shared commitments (honor code). This aligns tightly with the classical vision of **community and cultural practices**.

Aggregate Assessment

Overall Classicality Status: CLASSICAL

Across all six categories:

- **Religious & Metaphysical Foundations:** Strongly Christian, theological, and morally realist; no secular/relativist language.
- **Purpose & Goal:** Emphasis on **formation, virtue, wisdom**, and life under God, not merely college/-career.
- **Curriculum:** Explicit **classical Christian** identity and **ACCS candidacy**, with no evidence of social-studies/STEM-first/progressive curriculum framing.
- **Pedagogy:** Teacher-led, formative, biblically grounded; ACCS model implies Socratic, restful, and memory-based methods.
- **Faculty:** Teachers and leaders are **stewards** of students' moral and intellectual integrity, acting as mentors and exemplars.
- **Parents & Community:** Strong **parent partnership** and shared covenantal commitments.

The **keyword analysis** shows a **high density of positive classical terms** (virtue, integrity, stewardship, biblical commands, fear and admonition of the Lord, classical Christian education, ACCS) and **no significant negative/progressive lexicon hits** (no "values-neutral," "project-based learning," "21st-century skills," "social-emotional learning," etc.).

Therefore, the school's **aggregate rating** is:

CLASSICAL

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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